INTRODUCTION:

TALES OF SUSPENSE

Before his premiere movie became a box-office smash, Iron Man was not as instantly recognizable a commodity to the masses as the star-spangled Captain America, whose immense popularity was first sparked at the flashpoint of World War II. Nor was he as iconic as the Marvel Age phenomenon Spider-Man – who amazed patrons of pop culture the world over through comics, cartoons, movies and toys of every shape and size. Iron Man was never as ubiquitous as Wolverine and the X-Men or as attention-grabbing as the green-skinned giant, the Hulk. Tony Stark's armored alter ego is nonetheless one of comicdom's most popular and enduring characters. Conceived by Stan Lee and his stable mates of Silver Age innovation at the height of America's Cold War with the Soviet Union, Iron Man is still going strong in today's marketplace – stronger than ever, in fact. And after 45 years of continuous publication, one of the favorite sons of comics fandom has finally earned the adoration of the masses he so richly deserves.

